2.6 Native American Ways of Life in Texas

4th Grade Social Studies · Video: Native American Ways of Life Prior to European Colonization (San Antonio Missions NHP (MissionsNPS))

Name: _____ Date: _____

Watch the video and fill in the blanks as you go.

Visiting Mission San Juan

Ranger Melanie welcomes us to San Antonio Missions National Historical Park.

Mission San Juan Capistrano was established in San Antonio in _____.

At Mission San Juan, we can see the natural and _____ (farming) features of life at the missions.

The Yanaguana Trail is right behind Mission San Juan. Yanaguana is the Payaya people's name for the San Antonio River.

Life Before the Missions

Before the Spanish arrived, this land was home to many local _____ groups.

They worked, played, hunted, and gathered together in family groups called _____.

Many tribes came to this part of the South Texas Plains, including the Comanche and the _____.

They came because the area had plenty of _____ animals and other resources.

The Apache were already living here when the Comanche began their _____ migration.

The Comanche were skilled riders who had many _____.

Along the Trail

The trail has tall trees, birds, and the original channel of the San Antonio _____.

San Antonio Missions National Historical Park is also a UNESCO _____ site.

Knowing the Plants

Some plants are safe to eat, or _____, and very nutritious.

Other plants are _____ and can be very dangerous to people.

Hunters and gatherers had to know the difference between plants that were edible and plants that were not.

A good rule for dangerous plants is “Leaves of _____, let it be.”

Indigenous hunters and gatherers carried a tremendous _____ of all the plants in this area.

National parks help us preserve natural and _____ resources for future generations.

Vocabulary

Word	Meaning
band	a small family group that lived, worked, and hunted together
game	wild animals that people hunt for food
edible	safe to eat
toxic	poisonous; harmful to eat or touch
Indigenous	the first people to live in a place

Key Takeaways

• Before the Spanish arrived, Indigenous bands hunted and gathered along the San Antonio River.

• Knowing which plants were edible and which were toxic was key to survival.

• The Comanche and Lipan Apache came to South Texas because of its game and resources.